Four of these are twenty-three feet by eighteen and a half. They have windows now opening into the court, as well as the street. Where there are so many rooms, not to separate the men and women is certainly inexcusable.

The wards for felons are two rooms down a step or two; dark and dirty. One of them, the day-room, had a window to the street; through which spirituous liquors and tools for mischief might be easily conveyed: but it is now bricked up. The night-room is only eleven feet by nine: at one of my visits, men and women were lodged together in it. Two rooms over the felons' wards, which have been used as tap-rooms, seem to be intended for the women only, but in one of these I also found three men and four women lodged together. In the court, near the pump, there is the too common nuisance of a dunghill, which seems to have been accumulating for a year or two. Transports had not the king's allowance of 2s. 6d. a week. No infirmary: no bath. Act for preserving the health of prisoners not hung up. Prison not whitewashed for three years. Gaol delivery once a year. Few gaols have so many convenient rooms for common-side debtors. It is the more remarkable here, because there is no table signed by the magistrates to particularise the free wards. Some gaolers avail themselves of such a circumstance, and demand rent for rooms which were undoubtedly designed for common-side prisoners.

The gaol-fever, which some years ago carried off many of the prisoners, did not deter Mr. Farish from visiting the sick every day.

"1788, 2 Jan., Debtors 32.[1] Felons, etc., 20. Deserters 2."

[From *An Account of Lazarettos*, p. 200.]

[1] "Here was a prisoner, lately the widow of an old gentleman, who left her an estate of £300 per annum and about £7000 in mortgages. She was afterwards married in Scotland to a Mr. Milbourne of this city, who soon spent £4000, but upon some disagreement she refused to give up the mortgages of the other £3000. By an attachment from the Court of Chancery, her husband sent her to the common gaol, which confinement prevented her compliance with an order for appearance at that court in fifteen days of St. Hilary's term next ensuing. At first she was on the master's side; but the late gaoler, after cruelly seizing her clothes, etc., for chamber-rent, turned her to the common side. Her room (nine feet and a half by eight and a half) has no fire-place. She, not having the county allowance, supports herself by spinning and knitting, and the occasional kindness of her late husband's relations, while her present husband is living and rioting on her estate.

"By a letter dated 14 October, 1788, from a respectable gentleman at Carlisle, I am informed that Mrs. Milbourne is still in the gaol, and that for above two years, Mr. Milbourne did not give her one farthing, her subsistence being wholly on occasional charities, and the small earnings of spinning, at which employment she could not get more than fourpence, but now by practice and extremely close application (when health permits) can earn tenpence a week. In March last her husband sent her twenty shillings, and in October 1788 (twenty-seven weeks after) the same sum. The justices last quarter sessions commiserating her hardships, have allowed her the county bounty; the first shilling of which, this modest poor woman received, 11 October, 1788."

LANCASHIRE

COUNTY GAOL, LANCASTER CASTLE

The castle yard is spacious, and is supplied with water. Part of it is an enclosed bowling-green. Master's-side debtors have many apartments. One of them which they call the oven, is said to have been used as such in the time of John of Gaunt, Duke of Lancaster: the diameter, twenty-four feet; the height, that of an ordinary room. Debtors are allowed to walk and work (spin, knit, etc.) in the crown and shire halls. The latter is used as a chapel.[1]

One of the rooms for debtors (sixty feet by twenty-seven) is a free ward, and called the Quakers' room; because, it is said, when those people were so cruelly persecuted in the last century, vast numbers of them were confined in it.

Petty offenders are sometimes sent hither, because the bride-wells are distant. There is a large room for them near the gate; and they are kept separate from felons.

Men and women felons have their day-rooms apart, at the upper end of the court. Women sleep in their day-room: but the court being common, the men associate with them. Men have for their night-rooms two vaulted cells. One of them, the low dungeon, is ten steps underground,[2] twenty-one feet by nine, extremely close, dark, and unwholesome; very hot even in winter. Their other cell, the high dungeon (twenty feet two inches by eleven feet two), is close and offensive, though not underground; and has an iron-latticed door.

In one of these dungeons, there were three felons sick: the recorder, Mr. Fenton, gave immediate orders for their relief by better nourishment, etc., and they soon recovered. No infirmary: no bath. Transports had not the king's allowance

[1] Over the judge's bench in the shirehall is this text: "Let judgment run down as waters, and righteousness as a mighty stream."

[2] The gaoler's wine cellar is down twenty steps, and has evidently been used for the confinement of prisoners. The different purpose to which it is now applied is the only instance I know of the benefit of taps in gaols.